

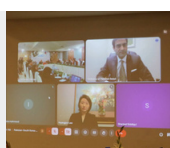
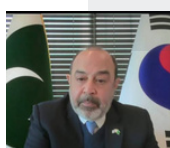
CAPES MONTHLY BRIEF

JANUARY 2026

ISSUE # 8

“

ADVANCING INDEPENDENT
DISCOURSE ON ASIA-PACIFIC
& EURASIA



PAKISTAN-SOUTH KOREA RELATIONS: EXPANDING CULTURAL AND EDUCATIONAL CONNECTIVITY

CAPES organized a hybrid international seminar to explore innovative ideas to strengthen educational and cultural ties between Pakistan and South Korea. The seminar brought together H.E. Amb. Moazzam Shah, industry leaders from the higher education sector of Korea, namely Prof. Choi Jong In, Vice President of Tongwon University, and Dr. Mun Yong Jo, President IADA (Korea), as well as Pakistani scholars with educational or teaching backgrounds in South Korea. One of the main agenda items of the seminar was to explore ideas to strengthen the proposed “Pakistan-Korea Knowledge Corridor”.



CULTURAL DIPLOMACY

TURKISH LANGUAGE CERTIFICATION

CAPES, in collaboration with the Embassy of Türkiye in Pakistan, has initiated a Turkish Language Course. The six-month course is certified by the Ministry of National Education of the Republic of Türkiye. The course is taught by Mr. Yusuf Zya Ozen, who is a certified instructor associated with the embassy. This CAPES initiative is aimed at enhancing cultural diplomacy as well as people-to-people contact between Pakistan and Türkiye.



MOU SIGNING WITH INDONESIAN STUDENTS ASSOCIATION ISLAMABAD (PPMI)

CAPES and the Indonesian Students Association Islamabad (PPMI) signed an MoU on January 23, 2026, at the Indonesian Corner, National Library of Pakistan, to formalize and strengthen educational, cultural, and people-to-people cooperation between Pakistan and Indonesia.



CAPES ONE-YEAR ANNIVERSARY CELEBRATIONS

CAPES has celebrated a year of meaningful growth, fueled by the unwavering commitment of our exceptional team. Together, we have strengthened the ties between Pakistan, the Asia-Pacific, and the Eurasian regions. Here's to continued collaboration and even greater achievements in the years to come.

MOU SIGNING CEREMONY BETWEEN CAPES AND SVI

CAPES and Strategic Vision Institute (SVI) have signed an MoU to enhance cooperation in research and policy dialogue in the fields of Asia Pacific and Eurasian Studies on January 06, 2026. Under the MoU, SVI and CAPES will collaborate in diverse areas, including joint research, training programs, seminars, and academic conferences.

VISIT BY DELEGATION OF FATIMA JINNAH WOMEN UNIVERSITY (FJWU)

CAPES was visited by a delegation from Fatima Jinnah Women University (FJWU) to discuss opportunities for joint collaboration between both institutions. The delegation was led by the Acting HOD. This collaboration is expected to enhance academic exchange and research opportunities between CAPES and FJWU.



Bangladesh shaken: Osman Hadi's killing, Tarique Rahman's return

CAPES GENERAL SECRETARY
UMAIR PERVEZ KHAN
WRITES FOR DAILY SABAH



<https://www.dailysabah.com/opinion/op-ed/bangladesh-shaken-osman-hadis-killing-tarique-rahmans-return>

"The killing of Sharif Osman Hadi, a popular student leader of Inqilab Mancha, a few weeks ago, has emerged as a defining political shock for Bangladesh at a critical transitional moment. Shot in the head by an unidentified masked assailant in Dhaka on Dec. 12 and later succumbing to his injuries in a Singapore hospital, Hadi's death has triggered widespread protests, deepened political polarization, and exposed the fragility of both domestic governance and foreign relations under the interim Yunus administration."

Why does India want to rename Indus Valley Civilization?

CAPES CHIEF ORGANISER
SARDAR BAKHSH
WRITES FOR SOUTH ASIA TIMES



<https://southasiatimes.org/why-does-india-want-to-rename-indus-valley-civilization/>

"India keenly wants the status of a great power for itself. One of the prerequisites that can legitimize its aspiration is its connection to ancient civilization. Indian media initiated a new debate focused on renaming the Indus Valley Civilization as the Sindhu-Sarasvati Civilization. Sarasvati is a mythical river mentioned in the holy books of Hinduism, the "Vedas". The struggle for renaming the Indus Valley Civilization has started a new debate on regional identities. Hence, if India succeeds in changing the name of this great ancient civilization as per its aspiration, it will have domestic and regional consequences."

Is the West facing its Sino-Soviet split moment?

**modern
diplomacy**
ALL VIEWS | ALL VOICES

CAPES CHIEF ORGANISER
SARDAR BAKHSH
WRITES FOR
MODERN DIPLOMACY

<https://moderndiplomacy.eu/2026/01/28/is-the-west-facing-its-sino-soviet-split-moment/>

"The annual meeting of the World Economic Forum was held at Davos, Switzerland, from 19 to 23 January 2026. This year's gathering is considered important as it has exposed the underlying differences and deep divisions within the transatlantic community. This is a moment which can be described as history repeating itself. What Euro-Atlantic community is facing today Communist world witnessed during the middle phase of cold war."

China's call for visible and verifiable actions against the militancy in Afghanistan

CAPES RESEARCHER
MUHAMMAD ASIF,
WRITES FOR
INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS FORUM

<https://www.ia-forum.org/Content/ViewInternalDocument.cfm?ContentID=21281>



"Pakistan has long carried a particular reputation. In foreign commentary, it was often reduced to a single idea: an Islamic country uneasy with difference, with its social fabric assumed to be brittle and its tolerance conditional. The image persisted not because it was always accurate, but because it was easy. By the end of 2025, that image looked increasingly out of step with what was visible on the ground."

Rethinking Pakistan's Palm Oil Dependency

CAPES RESEARCHER
YUSRA SARWAR
WRITES FOR THE DAILY TIMES



<https://dailytimes.com.pk/1439227/rethinking-pakistans-palm-oil-dependency/>

"The palm oil industry serves as a backbone of Pakistan's economy and food security. It serves as a strong anchor for relations between Pakistan and Southeast Asia. The import of palm oil from the two largest exporters of the world, i.e., Indonesia and Malaysia, to Pakistan serves as a strong bond between these two regions. This trade relationship has evolved beyond a transactional exchange, emerging as a strategic economic anchor."

Caricature to contrast

CAPES NON-RESIDENT FELLOW
MUHAMMAD UMAR,
WRITES FOR THE NEWS



<https://www.thenews.pk/print/1390812-caricature-to-contrast>

"Pakistan has long carried a particular reputation. In foreign commentary, it was often reduced to a single idea: an Islamic country uneasy with difference, with its social fabric assumed to be brittle and its tolerance conditional. The image persisted not because it was always accurate, but because it was easy. By the end of 2025, that image looked increasingly out of step with what was visible on the ground."



PAK-PACIFIC BRIEF

- Brunei research on Zakat management presented in Pakistan.
- Pakistan proposed an Inter-Governmental Agreement on mining cooperation with Australian High Commissioner Timothy Kane.
- Indonesia highlights potential role in supporting Pakistan's WHO maturity level.
- Pakistan-Vietnam ties highlighted by Parliamentary Friendship Group.
- Pakistan-Philippines pharma trade could reach \$1 billion, as vaccines, modern medicines, and local manufacturing are key areas to expand bilateral pharmaceutical trade.
- Pakistan and Australia Expand Agricultural Ties to Address Food Security.
- Pakistan and Indonesia close in on a jets and drones defence deal.
- Pakistani authorities cleared nearly 500 Vietnamese Tea Containers stranded at Karachi Port after prolonged transit disruptions.
- Pakistan-Indonesia Sign MoU to establish Joint Trade Committee.
- OGDC Explores Energy Partnerships in Vietnam.
- Pakistan seeks an early rice export deal with Indonesia, further explores kinnow export opportunities.
- Pak-Brunei relations strengthened through hockey diplomacy.
- President. President Asif Ali Zardari reaffirmed Pakistan's commitment to strengthening ties with Australia.
- Indonesia-Pakistan push to upgrade the preferential trade agreement to a comprehensive trade framework.
- Hawkesbury, Australia, welcomes 19 new citizens belonging to Pakistan.

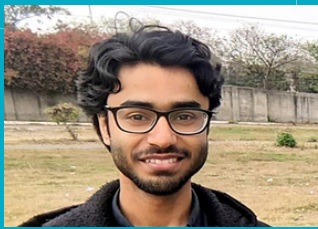


PAK-EURASIA BRIEF

- Pakistan's Ambassador to Russia formally presents credentials to President Putin.
- TAPI gas pipeline advances towards Herat, Afghanistan.
- Uzbek delegation visits Karachi Port Trust.
- Pakistan and Russia discuss resuming direct flights.
- Pakistani ports emerge as a strategic gateway for Uzbekistan's foreign trade.
- Kazakhstan plans to step up efforts to help resolve Pakistan-Afghanistan tensions.
- The 13th meeting of the Pakistan-Kazakhstan Joint Intergovernmental Commission was held to finalise trade and transit cooperation.
- Pakistan, Kazakhstan to sign MoU on \$7 bn rail link.
- Kyrgyzstan and Pakistan agree to conduct joint rescue exercises.
- Pakistan and Russia continue talks on reviving the Karachi steel plant.
- Pakistan and Kyrgyzstan agree to hold Kyrgyz Cultural Days in Islamabad.
- Uzbek and Kazakh presidents to visit Pakistan in February.
- Pakistan U16 football team makes historic UEFA debut in Kazakhstan.
- Uzbekistan, Pakistan Set 2026 Cooperation Priorities.
- CDA Chairman Meets Uzbek Ambassador in Islamabad.
- Deputy Prime Minister and Foreign Minister Ishaq Dar received a telephone call from the Foreign Minister of Uzbekistan Bakhtiyor Saidov.
- Islamabad to host Uzbekistan-Pakistan Business Forum & Textile Industrial Zone Proposal.

REMOTE INTERNSHIP PROGRAM

CA PES INTERNS' PUBLICATIONS



Pakistan's Geopolitical
Nexus of Payoffs &
Tradeoffs through INSTC

M. HAMZA CHAUDHARY
WRITES FOR THE HIMALYAN
RESEARCH INSTITUTE

<https://thrip.org/website/news/pakistan-geopolitical-nexus-of-payoffs-tradeoffs-through-instc>



The Sino-Pak
collaboration: A catalyst
for Pakistan's growth

**SYED IBTISAM UL HASSAN
GILLANI**
WRITES FOR STRATHEIA

<https://stratheia.com/the-sino-pak-collaboration-a-catalyst-for-pakistans-growth/>



Australia's Education
Shift: A Strategic Moment
Pakistan Cannot Afford to
Miss

FAREEHA AMJAD
WRITES FOR
THE DIPLOMATIC INSIGHT

<https://thediplomaticinsight.com/australias-education-shift-a-moment-pakistan-cannot-miss/>



The United States' Quest
for Rare Earth Minerals in
Asia-Pacific: Pakistan A
New Strategic Node

IBRAHIM KHAN
WRITES FOR STRATHEIA

<https://stratheia.com/the-united-states-quest-for-rare-earth-minerals-in-asia-pacific-pakistan-a-new-strategic-node/>



Pakistan Strengthens
Pacific Ties: Climate,
Agriculture, And Trade
At The Forefront

MOHAMMAD ADIL SANDHU
WRITES FOR NAYA DAUR

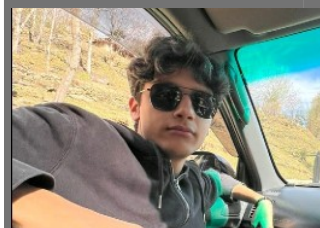
<https://nayadaur.tv/14-Jan-2026/pakistan-strengthens-pacific-ties-climate-agriculture-trade-forefront>



Lessons From the
Foggy Capitals of the
Asia Pacific

SARA KHAN
WRITES FOR STRATHEIA

<https://stratheia.com/lessons-from-the-foggy-capitals-of-the-asia-pacific/>



Why Does Asia Pacific
Remain Marginal In
Pakistan's Foreign
Policy?

UMAR BILAL RATHORE
WRITES FOR
PARADIGM SHIFT

<https://www.paradigmshift.com.pk/asia-pacific-policy/>



Goodwill Without
Gains?

ZAINAB ASGHAR
WRITES FOR STRATHEIA

<https://stratheia.com/goodwill-without-gains/>



Digging into the
Future

HAFSA FATIMA
WRITES FOR STRATHEIA

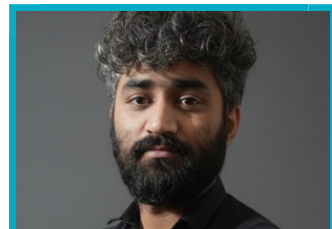
<https://stratheia.com/digging-into-the-future/>



Pakistan-Bangladesh
Rapprochement: Promise
of New Maritime Corridor

FARYAL GOHAR BATOOL
WRITES FOR
SOUTH ASIA TIMES

<https://southasiatimes.org/pakistan-bangladesh-rapprochement-promise-of-new-maritime-corridor/>



India's Act East Policy
in 2025: When It
Turned China-Centric

ASAD AMANAT ALI
WRITES FOR STRATHEIA

<https://stratheia.com/indias-act-east-policy-in-2025-when-it-turned-china-centric/>